

Wonderful water

Water is vital to life. It is an essential part of every tissue in your body, including your bones, and makes up more than half your body weight. If your water content falls by just 10 percent you can get seriously ill. But your body is always losing water, so it has a special system that makes you drink when you need to.

FEELING THIRSTY?

You can go without food for a long time, but your body needs a regular supply of water to replace all the moisture that it loses. Some is made by chemical reactions in body cells that produce metabolic water, but the rest is in your food and drink. Part of your brain called the hypothalamus monitors the water in your blood, and if the level is too low it triggers the thirsty feeling that makes you take a drink.



► **IN AND OUT**
The water that you take in balances the water lost in urine, sweat, feces (poo), and even in the moist air that you breathe out.

◀ **WATER COOLER**
As you exercise you heat up and start sweating. The moisture on your skin then evaporates and cools you down—but this uses up body moisture that must be replaced with more water.

